

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex, document-intensive legal matters at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in managing case files, coordinating documents and actions across competing deadlines, preparing bundles and procedural materials, and communicating with clients and external parties. Comfortable working across international matters involving multiple stakeholders. Keen to apply this in a transactional paralegal context.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding document actions, tracked what was needed from the client, and liaised with an external Romanian translator to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines across a multi-party, cross-border matter
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons; maintained matter records via iManage
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **Legal Adviser**

July 2026 – Present

- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across a range of matter types
- Translates complex procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients; advises on options and next steps

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the matter deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review and electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence drafting

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, electronic hearing bundles, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters